



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Cheetah!

Vulnerable

Facts • Colour • Activities

Cheetah Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Acinonyx jubatus
Status:	Vulnerable
Where they live:	Sub-Saharan Africa; small population in Iran
Habitat:	Open grasslands and bushy areas in parts of Africa and the Middle East
Diet:	Carnivore — gazelles, impalas, wildebeest calves, hares
Weight:	21–65 kg
Lifespan:	10–12 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 7,100 in the wild

Amazing Facts ■

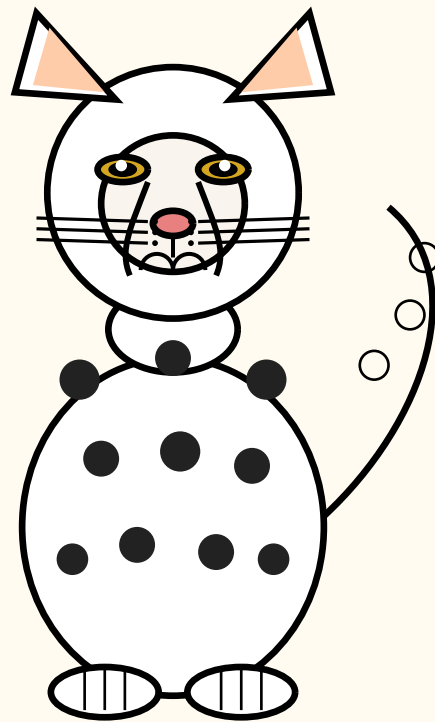
- The cheetah is the fastest land animal, reaching 97–113 km/h (60–70 mph) over short distances.
- Unlike other big cats, cheetahs cannot roar — but they purr, chirp, and even bark!
- A cheetah's spots are solid black dots; a leopard's are hollow rosette shapes.
- Bold black 'tear stripes' run from inner eye corners to the mouth, reducing sun glare.
- After a chase, a cheetah must rest about 30 minutes to cool down before it can eat.
- Cheetah mums have 4–6 cubs and spend 18 months teaching them to hunt.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Habitat loss as grasslands are converted to farmland	CRITICAL
2	Conflict with farmers protecting livestock	HIGH
3	Illegal wildlife trade — cubs taken as exotic pets	HIGH
4	Prey depletion from overhunting	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Cheetah

Cheetahs are tawny yellow with solid black spots. Their underside is white; two solid black 'tear stripes' run from eye to mouth.



Activities ➡

Word Search — find all 8 words!

I	C	H	E	E	T	A	H	M	D	J	I
P	S	P	O	T	S	Y	I	F	P	C	E
R	G	B	S	R	O	Z	L	A	R	L	N
C	J	R	M	J	G	Q	C	S	E	T	D
G	U	U	A	F	M	C	Z	T	D	D	A
U	W	Q	O	S	H	L	J	E	A	L	N
T	T	S	A	Q	S	U	X	S	T	M	G
X	D	E	I	F	A	L	N	T	O	T	E
V	N	J	G	S	R	V	A	T	R	L	R
V	J	R	L	P	T	I	G	N	I	G	E
I	K	Q	Z	Y	K	N	C	H	D	N	D
S	M	B	V	R	Y	W	A	A	U	V	G

CHEETAH	GRASSLAND	PREDATOR	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	FASTEST	SPOTS	HUNTING

Match It Up!

Cheetah		work to protect wildlife
Grassland		a cheetah's favourite prey
Gazelle		black lines under the eyes
Tear stripes		fastest land animal
Conservation		the cheetah's habitat

Fill in the Blanks!

- The cheetah can reach _____ km/h over short distances.
- Cheetahs have solid black _____ on their fur.
- Unlike other big cats, cheetahs cannot _____.
- Cheetahs are found mainly in _____ Africa.

Answers: 113 | spots | roar | Sub-Saharan

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